



NOUNS

The words that name people, places and things

1 What is it?

Nouns (nounz)

A noun is a word that names a person, place, thing, animal or idea. Nouns are one of the most basic building blocks of every sentence.

person / place / thing / idea

2 See it in action

Person

"The **teacher** praised the **student**."

Place

"We walked through the **park** to the **station**."

Thing

"She packed her **bag** with a **book** and a **phone**."

Idea

"His **courage** and **honesty** impressed everyone."



You got this!

Try spotting every noun in a sentence from your last piece of writing — you'll usually find more than you expect.

3 More to know

Animal

"The **cat** chased the **mouse** across the **garden**."

Collective

"A **team** of players joined the **crowd**."

FUN FACT

English has roughly 600,000 nouns in the full Oxford English Dictionary — but most fluent speakers only actively use around 20,000 of them.

4 Why it's used

Nouns help: name the people, places, things and ideas a sentence is actually about — without them, a sentence has no subject to talk about.

Nouns can be common (dog, city), proper (London, Sarah — always capitalised), concrete (something you can touch, like a chair) or abstract (an idea, like freedom).



Think about...

If you can put 'the' or 'a' in front of a word and it still makes sense, it's very likely a noun.

5 Where you'll spot it

Common vs proper

Common nouns are general (city, dog); proper nouns name a specific one and get a capital letter (London, Rex).

Concrete vs abstract

Concrete nouns you can touch or see (table, rain); abstract nouns are ideas or feelings you can't (freedom, honesty).

⚠ Watch out!

Don't confuse a noun with an adjective describing it — in "the red car", car is the noun; red is describing it, not naming a separate thing.

6 Quick recap

Names people, places, things

Can be common or proper

Every sentence needs one



Look here!

Proper nouns always get a capital letter, wherever they sit in a sentence — not just at the start.